



Air Plasma Engine

Scientists have created an 'air plasma' engine that works without fossil fuels. <https://digit.in/jun20-42>



Netflix stops charging

Netflix will stop charging accounts that are paying but haven't watched anything in over a year. <https://digit.in/jun20-43>

GENRE-BENDING DIRECTION

How directors
manipulate genre to
their will

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very once in a while we come across a director that creates something totally unique. They do not

desire to follow the regular norms of direction. Which is setting up a base mood and tone for the audience. So, they choose to mix and match genres to their will. This process of filmmaking is called genre-bending. Through this, some intend to introduce a completely new genre to the world while others just happen to do it unintentionally while telling their story. The most common form of genre-bending is plainly telling a linear story by mixing up two different genres into one. For instance, in dark or mystery animes, the writers or directors add a hint of comedy into the story. The comedic aspect loosens up the tension in the story. This acts as a stress release by freshening the mind of the audience, before stepping into the darker aspects of the story again. Sometimes these comedic elements act as an illusion to trick the audience into thinking that the story's eventual ending would not be that serious or dark. This way, the directors induce a shock-factor from the audience. The other way of doing this is introducing more than two genres into the story while also leaving the interpretation of the story or idea up to the audience. Achieving this is extremely difficult. As a director, you do get an apprecia-



A still from *Batman V Superman: Dawn of Justice*

tion for the unique idea or the concept. However, the end product would not get accepted as a decent art piece and the director gets criticised for having their head in the clouds. However, there are some directors who have achieved this great feat in filmmaking by earning immense respect for their work without being labelled as just some washed-up creator with an inflated ego. Let us take a look at some of these genre-bending directors and how they used genre-bending to tell their stories and initiate a conversation from the audience.



ZACK SNYDER

Ever since the dawn of superhero movies, superheroes have gained popularity amongst the general folk. The very idea of seeing their favourite superhero take on their respective supervillains in a linear storyline was very much appealing to the public. Director Zack Snyder, however, took a different approach to superhero films with his Snyder-Verse. He revolutionized the DC Comics movies industry with a darker and gritty storyline, excellent

cinematography and bending genre to his will in order to get his point across. Zack explored superheroes in a unique way by keeping it as realistic and relatable as possible. Zack's genre-bending style was most apparent in his 2016 movie, *Batman V Superman: Dawn of Justice*. Despite the base plot being a battle between The World's Finest, Zack wanted to convey a deeper message. To achieve this, he introduced additional genres into the existing superhero genre. Politics and mythology with hints of philosophy.

Zack introduced Superman into a modern-day political environment. This was done by asking the question, "Must there be a Superman?" and building up a controversial topic surrounding the situation. Whether Superman is a good guy or a bad guy, he is an alien at the end of the day. An alien who was adopted into planet Earth. He was a saviour who asked for nothing in return. Is it necessary to make an alien abide by the rules of humanity created by the government of the Earth? Should there be separate laws created around this figure to restrain his decision making and actions? Zack also brought up the idea of Superman turning heel by questioning his morality by